

Desk Research

1. The problem

Pollinators such as bees, butterflies, hoverflies and moths are essential parts of ecosystems. They help flowering plants reproduce, and pollination also supports food production. The European Commission reports that around 4 out of 5 crop and wild flowering plant species depend on animal pollination, while the EEA estimates that around 78% of wildflower species in the EU depend on insect pollination.

At the same time, wild pollinators in Europe are declining. The European Commission reports that 1 in 3 bee, butterfly and hoverfly species is in decline, and 1 in 10 bee and butterfly species is threatened with extinction.

The problem statement is :

The decline of pollinators can disrupt the relationships between plants, insects and other organisms that keep ecosystems functioning.

2. SDG 13 - Climate Action

SDG 13 focuses on taking urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts.

Our project connects to SDG 13 because climate change is one of the pressures affecting pollinators and ecosystems.

The EEA identifies climate change and extreme weather as pressures on pollinators. Drought and heavy rainfall can affect the availability of floral resources, while increasing temperatures can shift flowering times and disrupt plant-pollinator networks.

3. User Group

Primary Users

Young adults aged 18–30, especially university students and young social-media users who may know about climate change but have limited awareness of its impact on pollinators and ecosystems.

Secondary Users

Teachers, environmental organisations, and general audiences who could use or share the film for climate-awareness and educational purposes.

Excluded / Not for Users

Climate scientists, ecologists, and policymakers who already have specialist knowledge and do not need a short awareness film to understand the issue.

4. Existing Solutions

There are already different ways to help protect pollinators:

- **Creating better habitats:** More wildflowers, meadows, and natural areas give pollinators food and places to live.
- **Reducing pesticides:** Using fewer harmful pesticides can help protect bees and other insects.
- **Monitoring pollinators:** The EU is developing systems to track changes in pollinator populations.
- **EU Pollinators Initiative:** The EU supports research, conservation, and public awareness around pollinator decline.

These solutions focus mainly on **protecting habitats, reducing threats, and understanding the problem better.**

5. Ethical Considerations

Because our film uses AI-generated visuals, we need to make sure it does not mislead people.

- **AI images:** We will use a fictional garden rather than presenting an AI-generated event as real.
- **Scientific accuracy:** We will not suggest that climate change is the only cause of pollinator decline. It is one of several pressures.
- **Visual storytelling:** The silent garden is a metaphor, not a prediction of what every ecosystem will look like.
- **AI energy use:** We will record how many generations we created and consider whether the energy used was justified by the educational purpose of the film.

6. Current Existing Solutions

There are already several efforts to protect pollinators:

- **Habitat restoration:** creating more flower-rich and natural areas.
- **Pesticide reduction:** reducing harmful exposure to pollinators.
- **Pollinator monitoring:** tracking changes in pollinator populations.
- **EU conservation programs:** supporting research, protection, and public awareness.
- **Climate adaptation:** helping ecosystems deal with heat, drought, and extreme weather.

These solutions are already being used by governments, researchers, and environmental organisations.

Our Opportunity

We are **not trying to create another solution for saving bees**. Instead, we focus on **awareness and communication**.

Our question is:

How can we make this complex problem understandable and emotionally meaningful in just 30 seconds?

The Silent Garden addresses this through a short visual story that shows nature gradually becoming silent.

7. Sources

1. European Environment Agency (EEA)

Protecting and restoring Europe's wild pollinators and their habitats

<https://www.eea.europa.eu/en/analysis/publications/protecting-and-restoring-europes-wild-pollinators-and-their-habitats>

2. European Commission

Pollinators

https://environment.ec.europa.eu/topics/nature-and-biodiversity/pollinators_en

3. **European Commission**

EU Pollinators Initiative: A New Deal for Pollinators

https://environment.ec.europa.eu/topics/nature-and-biodiversity/pollinators_en

4. **IPBES**

Assessment Report on Pollinators, Pollination and Food Production

<https://www.ipbes.net/fr/ppa>

5. **IPBES**

Full Assessment Report on Pollinators, Pollination and Food Production

<https://files.ipbes.net/ipbes-web-prod-public->

[files/downloads/pdf/2017_pollination_full_report_book_v12_pages.pdf](https://files.ipbes.net/ipbes-web-prod-public-files/downloads/pdf/2017_pollination_full_report_book_v12_pages.pdf)